

lure to enquire into who was responsible for the July 1983 violence as he did after the 1977 violence (the Sansoni Commission), despite an undertaking given to a United Nations Subcommittee that he would do so, is as damning as anything such an enquiry could unearth.

During the massive destruction of life and property, the armed forces and police did nothing and in many instances assisted the mobs by supplying them with petrol.

This underscores once again that during times of national violence, the Security Forces of Sri Lanka are only for the security of a section of the population, i.e. the Sinhalese people.

The Tamil massacre would have been much more comprehensive had it not been for the bravery of more civilised Sinhalese who literally hid Tamils in their homes, running terrible risks themselves.

The aftermath

There have been serious repercussions both at home and abroad.

The damage done to the economy by Tamil professionals and industrialists leaving Sri Lanka in droves cannot yet be assessed fully. It would be naive to believe that these businessmen will reinvest in this volatile country.

Tourism has suffered a devastating blow and many hotels face bankruptcy.

The Sri Lankan image abroad has taken its worst beating in history. More damaging than anything a Sri Lankan Tamil abroad can say are publications by the International Commission of Jurists, the Catholic Commission for Justice and Peace, the World Council of Churches and Amnesty International, which have come out with blistering reports about the violation of human rights in Sri Lanka.

The last named has also repeatedly requested the withdrawal of laws that enable the Security Forces to perpetrate torture and murder without fear of investigation.

Government attempts to win the propaganda war by listing members of the Security Forces killed, have not made a major impact. If men don uniforms, equip themselves with sophisticated weapons and get killed in the process, is it a cause for complaint or justification for turning their guns on the Tamil community in Jaffna who have nothing to do with the violence of a section of their youth?

The continuing security of the Tamil people in Sri Lanka is in considerable doubt. Jayawardene's statement that he cannot guarantee

the safety of the Tamils in Colombo if there is a threat from India, has been justifiably criticised by the Chief Justice whom the President has threatened with impeachment.

Lawlessness

If Jayawardene cannot guarantee the safety of his citizens, he should quit his position instead of promoting lawlessness, embarrassing the legislature and pushing democracy into totalitarianism.

The current problem is the indiscriminate killing of innocent Tamils, in particular the Tamil youth in Jaffna by the armed forces in the hope that some of them may be terrorists. The terrorists they are after are probably watching their activities from South India. If and when they retaliate, there will be a bloodbath that would make the July 1983 massacre seem trivial.

The most worrying prospect is the potential for internationalisation of this domestic conflict. America is already assisting the Sri Lankan armed forces which may be advance payment for the strategic naval base in Trincomalee.

India, by sending her Foreign Minister at the height of the trouble, has made her presence felt and will feel threatened by the American presence in Trincomalee. South India is turning a blind eye to the militant youth training there. To internationalise the situation would be to turn Sri Lanka into another Lebanon.

Grandiose view

The author is neither a Tamil Tiger terrorist nor a chauvinist Sinhalese with the grandiose view that Sri Lanka belongs only to the Sinhalese. He does not support the guerrilla terrorism of the Tigers, the military terrorism of the Security Forces or the political terrorism of Sri Lankan governments present or past with their political dishonesty. His only concern is the stopping of violence in Sri Lanka. Historically, no conflict has been settled by terrorism.

If a division of the country will bring peace to Sri Lanka, this will be more acceptable to the author, a full-blooded Sinhalese, than an internal conflict that could go on for decades with a massive loss of life and property and total disruption of the country.

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REMEMBER

JULY 1983

MASSACRE OF TAMILS

IN SRI LANKA

2,000 murdered . . .
100,000 made homeless
53 political prisoners
slaughtered in the cells
Mass arrests & torture

**FIGHT
PRESIDENT
JAYAWARDENE'S
REIGN OF
TERROR**

**Demonstration
SAT 28 JULY 84**

**Assemble 12.30
HYDE PARK**

**RALLY at
TRAFALGAR
SQUARE**

Eelam Solidarity Campaign

DEVANESAN NESIAH LEAVES FOR USA

Jaffna's Government Agent, Mr Devanesan Nesiah left for the USA at the end of last month. He is the recipient of a John F. Kennedy Memorial Scholarship to follow a post-graduate course in Public Administration at Harvard.

It was expected that Mr N. Vamadeva, a former Commissioner of the Marketing Department, would succeed him. Meanwhile, Additional GA, Jaffna, Mr M. Panchalingam is acting for GA, Jaffna.